

film review A Flat Joke

FOOL N FINAL

Starring: Shahid Kapur,
Sunny Deol, Ayesha Takia
Directed by: Ahmed Khan

While most Bollywood filmmakers are experimenting with themes, some are trapped in a time warp. Firoz Nadiadwala, a flashy mix of Jerry Bruckheimer and the late Don Simpson, is one of them—his movies wear their big budgets like red badges of honour. So there are some stunts, some hip hop clothes, vast expanses of desert, even a Mike Tyson,



Takia and Kapur but nothing redeems this foolhardy enterprise, not even a fine assemblage of comics from Paresch Rawal to Johnny Lever. The jokes are flat, the actors are wasted (even the fetching

Takia and Deol, now increasingly playing a caricature of himself). Not worth watching even for the morbid fascination of watching Mr Nadiadwala blow up his money.

by Kaverie Bamzai

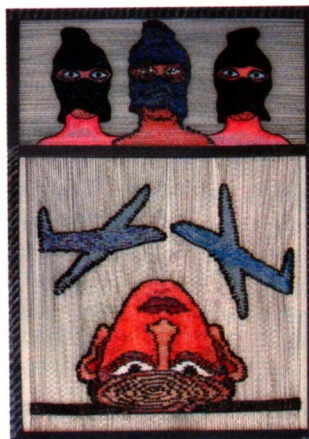
recommendations Shaping Thoughts

MUMBAI The sculptural works by Valay Shende remain untitled because the idea behind it was to be thought provoking. Conceptualised to be a reconstruction of earth, Shende explains, "I consider myself one of the few artists out to make the world a happy place." The exhibition includes sculptural installations with titles
A Valay installation



like 'Buddha Right, Marx Wrong'. This piece attempts to explain that though both Marx and Buddha preached equality, while one proposed a middle path, the other took to revolution. For the same goal, both followed two starkly different paths. On at Sakshi Art Gallery till June 30.

KOLKATA 'Intimate Thoughts: Pristine Fables' showcases works by eight modern women artists—Chandana Hore, Pampa Punwar, Rima Kundu, Shrabani Roy, Mahajabin Majumdar among others—from Santiniketan. The show, jointly curated by Pranabranjan Ray and Nandini Ghosh, will open with a panel discussion tracing the evolution of the female artist from the early 20th century on-

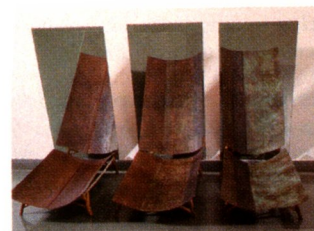


Intimate Thoughts exhibits works by women artists wards. The discussion features Nandini Ghosh and Aparna Roy and will be moderated by Tapati Guha Thakurta, head, journalism department, Calcutta University. At Akar Prakar from June 11-24.

by Swati Mathur and Swagata Sen

art Inner Search

BANGALORE Lalitha Shankar's new line of sculptures 'In Search of Consciousness' is a series



A work by Shankar of drawings and sculptures exploring consciousness. 'Mahabindu', her works in mild steel and steel ropes, depict the path to the ultimate bindu or the non-dual state of oneness. At the Sumukha Gallery till June 23.

MUMBAI The Environment-Space Experiential is an experience for all animal lovers. Conceptualised by artist Himanshu S., the exhibition is an artistic attempt to sensitise people against doing away with or killing stray animals. Himanshu uses soft-toy dogs placed on green acrylic at a reasonable distance from each other to form a random formation through which people will be able to walk. "For those of us involved in this exhibition, animals are our loved ones. We have gone through the pain of losing them. And now we don't beg for a space for them", explains Himanshu. On till June 23 at the Guild Art Gallery.

by Swati Mathur

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